



Subprograms

CS3204N Programming Languages

What is a Subprogram?

A **subprogram** is a reusable block of code that performs a specific task

Two main types:

- **Function** → returns a value
- **Procedure** → does not return a value

Simple Example (C)

```
int add(int a, int b) {  
    return a + b;  
}
```

```
int main() {  
    int result = add(3, 5);  
    printf("%d", result);  
}
```

Execution Flow

- Main program calls subprogram
- Control transfers to subprogram
- Subprogram executes
- Control returns to caller

Call stack: **main** → **add** → **return** → **main**

Why Use Subprograms?

- Avoid repetition
- Improve readability
- Enable modular design

Subprogram Structure

Header:

- Name
- Parameters
- Return type

Body:

- Statements

Formal vs Actual Parameters

```
int multiply(int x, int y) { // formal parameters
    return x * y;
}
```

```
multiply(4, 6); // actual parameters
```

Return Values (Multiple Values Example - Python)

```
def compute(a, b):  
    return a + b, a * b
```

```
sum_val, prod_val = compute(2, 3)
```


Side Effects Example

```
int x = 10;
```

```
void modify() {  
    x = 20; // side effect  
}
```

Local Variables

```
void func() {  
    int x = 5; // local  
}
```

Global vs Local

```
int x = 10;
```

```
void func() {  
    int x = 5;  
    printf("%d", x);  
}
```

Static Scope

Variable is resolved based on **where it is written in code.**

```
int x = 10;
```

```
void func() {  
    printf("%d", x);  
}
```

Dynamic Scope

Variable is resolved based on **who called the function**

```
function A() {  
  x = 10  
  B()  
}
```

```
function B() {  
  print(x)  
}
```

Pass-by-Value

A copy of the value is passed

```
void change(int x) {  
    x = 50;  
}
```

```
int main() {  
    int a = 10;  
    change(a);  
    printf("%d", a); // 10  
}
```

Memory Illustration

- $a = 10 \rightarrow$ copied to x
- x changes $\rightarrow$ a unaffected

Pass-by-Reference

Address of variable is passed

```
void change(int &x) {  
    x = 50;  
}
```

Output becomes: 50

Swap Example

```
void swap(int &a, int &b) {  
    int temp = a;  
    a = b;  
    b = temp;  
}
```

Pass-by-Result

```
procedure add(out x)  
  x = 10
```

Pass-by-Value-Result

Copy in → modify → copy out

Pass-by-Name

Expression is evaluated every time it is used.

```
procedure example(x)  
  print(x)
```

Call:

```
example(a + b)
```

Comparison Table

Method	Input	Output	Side Effects
Value	Yes	No	No
Reference	Yes	Yes	Yes
Result	No	Yes	Yes
Value-Result	Yes	Yes	Yes

Example

```
def apply(func, x):  
    return func(x)
```

```
def square(n):  
    return n * n
```

```
print(apply(square, 5))
```

Function Pointer

Variable that stores a function

```
int add(int a, int b) {  
    return a + b;  
}
```

```
int (*funcPtr)(int, int) = add;  
funcPtr(2, 3);
```

Pure Function

No side effects.

```
def add(a, b):  
    return a + b
```


Impure Function

Output may change due to external variables

```
x = 10
```

```
def change():  
    global x  
    x = 20
```

Impure Function

```
x = 10
```

```
def change():  
    global x  
    x = 20
```

Overloading

```
int add(int a, int b);  
double add(double a, double b);
```

Generics

Function works for many data types.

C++ Template Example

```
template <typename T>
T add(T a, T b) {
    return a + b;
}
```

Operator Overloading

Operators behave differently for objects

```
class Point {  
public:  
    int x, y;  
    Point operator+(Point p) {  
        return {x + p.x, y + p.y};  
    }  
};
```

Closures

Inner function “remembers” x

```
function outer() {  
    let x = 10;  
    return function inner() {  
        return x;  
    };  
}
```

Coroutines

Function pauses and resumes

Python Generator Example

```
def counter():  
    yield 1  
    yield 2  
    yield 3
```

Coroutine Behavior

Pause → Resume → Continue